single biggest failure of the NDA government this MOTN, followed closely by unemployment. Voters also count farm distress and falling family incomes among the biggest problems India is facing today. Taken together, economic issues account for 54.4 per cent of the failures of the government. This, despite India continuing to be one of the world's fastest-growing major economies and the Modi government winning plaudits for maintaining steady growth amid global turbulence. Optimism about the larger national goal persists as well, with close to 58 per cent of respondents enthusiastic about Modi's vision of turning India into a Viksit Bharat, or developed India, by 2047.

Elsewhere in the poll, however, unhappiness over the economic situation comes through loud and clear. Close to half of those surveyed now rate the NDA government's handling of the economy as either 'average' or 'poor'. Nor is there much optimism about what lies ahead: a majority—54.5 per cent—believe the economy will either 'remain the same' or 'get worse' in the coming months. Concerns over income inequality are equally pronounced, with 43.7 per cent believing that the rich have benefited the most from the Modi government's policies. That perception is reinforced by the 55.7 per cent who feel big business has gained the most from the government's economic initiatives, at the expense of small businesses and farmers. A striking 65 per cent say they find it difficult to balance their household budgets without going into debt. And close to two-thirds of those polled describe the unemployment situation as either 'very serious' or 'serious'. Together, these findings point to a widening gap between India's impressive headline growth numbers and the sense of economic security felt by ordinary households.

The govt is credited with stability, but that very virtue is fuelling Gen Z's impatient with the status quo and its demand for change

UNEMPLOYMENT WOES

Unemployment also tops the list of worries for Gen Z—those born between 1997 and 2012, who constitute around 30 per cent of the electorate. Given the angst and anger among young people that erupted first at Jantar Mantar, giving rise to the CJP, and later in Jharkhand, this MOTN includes a separate study of their mood. The findings show that Gen Z broadly moves in the same direction as the overall voting population on most issues, but is noticeably more critical and anxious when it comes to jobs, governance and its own future (see accompanying report, *Anger and Angst of the Young*).

Even in the main survey, when Gen Z respondents are considered separately, they give Modi a significantly lower performance rating than other popula-

Methodology

The INDIA TODAY Mood of the Nation (MOTN) poll was conducted by CVoter, a globally renowned name in the field of socio-economic research, between July 1 and August 25, interviewing 25,184 respondents covering all Lok Sabha segments across all states. In addition to these samples, 91,795 interviews from CVoter's regular tracker data over the past 24 weeks, were also analysed for the long-term trendline in projections calculation of votes and seats. Thus, the opinion of a total of 116,644 respondents was considered for this MOTN report. The margin of error is +/- 3 percent at the macro level and +/- 5 per cent at the micro level of reporting, with 95 per cent confidence level.

From May 2009 onwards, the CVoter Tracker has been carried out each week, 52 waves in a calendar year, in 11 national languages, across all states and UTs in India, with a target sample size of 60,000 each quarter. The average response rate is 55 per cent. Starting January 1, 2019, CVoter has been carrying the tracker on a daily basis, using the rollover sample of seven days for tracker analysis.

All these polls are based on a random probability sample as used in the globally standardised methodology, conducted by trained researchers across all geographic and demographic segments. This survey is based on CATI interviews of adult respondents across all segments. Standard RDD is used to draw random numbers covering all frequency series allocated to all operators across all telecom circles in India.

CVoter ensures proper representative analysis by statistical weighing of the data to make it representative of the local population as per the latest census figures. The data are weighted to the known census profile, including gender, age, education, income, religion, caste, urban/rural and vote recalls for the last Lok Sabha and Vidhan Sabha elections. For the analytics, CVoter uses its proprietary algorithm to calculate the provincial and regional vote share based on the split-voter phenomenon.

CVoter follows the code of professional ethics and practices drafted by the World Association of Public Opinion Research and the official guidelines on opinion polling as instructed by the Press Council of India. ■